

Across the *Sea*

Only one thing comes first.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 8:18-34 in the LSB | 33:27 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The HIDDEN Truth Behind Jesus & The Legion of Demons (and MORE) (Matthew 8:18-34). Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 8:18-34: a scribe and another disciple offer to follow Jesus; a great storm hits the boat while Jesus sleeps, and He rebukes the winds and sea; on the other side, in the region of the Gadarenes, He casts demons out of two men into a herd of swine.
- The scribe wants to follow, unusually for a scribe, and Jesus warns that the Son of Man has nowhere to lay His head. The second man asks first to bury his father. The video takes Jesus' answer as hard as it sounds: 'leave the spiritually dead to bury their own physically dead.'
- The storm is a seismos, the word for an earthquake, as at the cross and the empty tomb (27:54; 28:2). Jesus rebukes the sea the way He rebukes unclean spirits. The video says Jews saw the sea as the watery chaos of Genesis 1:2 and the abyss: a gateway to the underworld.
- Geography matters: the far shore is the Gentile Decapolis, which the video links with Bashan, seen as the entry to the underworld. Using Deuteronomy 32:8, Psalm 82, Psalm 68 and Ephesians 4:8 (following Michael Heiser), it says Jesus is reclaiming the nations from rebel spiritual powers. 'Before the time' (8:29) shows the demons know their end is coming.
- The lesson centers on Elisha's call in 1 Kings 19: he asked to kiss his parents, then sacrificed his oxen and followed with nothing to go back to. Luke adds, 'No one,

> *"Geography is important. The authors don't mention geography for no reason.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Jesus does not merely calm this storm. He appears to exorcise the storm.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

after putting his hand to the plow and looking back, is fit for the kingdom of God' (Luke 9:62).

- To be a disciple, the only thing that comes first is doing the will of the Father (6:33; 7:21). There is no checklist of things to do first, and no room for double-mindedness, the hypocrite's condition.



The storm on the Sea of Galilee

Rembrandt, The Storm on the Sea of Galilee, 1633. Via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



Jesus stilling the tempest

James Tissot, Jesus Stilling the Tempest, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Study it again

The teacher's tip: when this study is done, go back and do a new study of the same passage. You should find more than one lesson every time, because God's word is that deep. Also read the parallels: Mark 4:35-5:20 and Luke 8:22-39.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 8:18-34, the parallels in Mark and Luke, Elisha's call, and passages about the nations and Bashan. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 8:18–34
Read in full: two would-be disciples, the storm, the Gadarene demoniacs.

Luke 9:57–62
Luke's would-be disciples, with the plow saying.

1 Kings 19:16–21
Elijah throws his mantle on Elisha.

Luke 14:28–33
Count the cost.

Genesis 1:2
Darkness over the surface of the deep.

Mark 4:35–41
Mark's storm: 'Silence! Be still.'

Mark 5:1–20
Mark's demoniac: 'My name is Legion.'

Luke 8:26–39
Luke's account: they beg not to go into the abyss.

Deuteronomy 32:8–9
The Most High sets the boundaries of the peoples.

Psalm 82
God judges the 'sons of the Most High.'

Psalm 68:15–18
The mountain of Bashan; 'You have ascended on high.'

Ephesians 4:8
Paul quotes Psalm 68 of Christ's triumph.

Matthew 9:1–17
Coming next (Episode 14): the paralytic, Matthew's call, and fasting.

Key verses in the LSB

> "The foxes have holes and the birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay His head."
> Matthew 8:20 (LSB)

> "What kind of a man is this, that even the winds and the sea obey Him?"
> Matthew 8:27 (LSB)

> "No one, after putting his hand to the plow and looking back, is fit for the kingdom of God."
> Luke 9:62 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Follow Me: two would-be disciples

Jesus' hard answers, read beside Elisha's call.



THE SCRIBE · MATTHEW 8:19-20

Nowhere to lay His head

MATTHEW 8:19-20 (LSB)

COST

“Then a scribe came and said to Him, “Teacher, I will follow You wherever You go.” And Jesus said to him, “The foxes have holes and the birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay His head.””

FROM THE VIDEO Scribes were experts in the Law of Moses; some served in the temple, the royal court, or the Sanhedrin. Unusually, this one wants to be a disciple.

FROM THE VIDEO If the rabbi is homeless, so are His disciples. For a scribe of standing, this was a hard word. Doing the Father's will may mean choosing it over a pillow.

BACKGROUND This is Matthew's first use of 'Son of Man,' Jesus' favorite name for Himself (compare Daniel 7:13). Daniel 7:13

◆ Factbook: Scribe ◆ Factbook: Sanhedrin



THE DISCIPLE · MATTHEW 8:21-22

Let the dead bury their own dead

MATTHEW 8:21-22 (LSB)

FIRST

“And another of the disciples said to Him, “Lord, permit me first to go and bury my father.” But Jesus said to him, “Follow Me, and allow the dead to bury their own dead.””

FROM THE VIDEO Do not soften it. The video reads: let the spiritually dead bury their own physically dead.

FROM THE VIDEO Many scholars think 'bury my father' was an idiom: let me stay until my father dies, then I will follow.

BACKGROUND Chrysostom read the father as already dead: 'what can be more needful than to bury a father?' Even so, he says, 'it is far better to proclaim the kingdom' (Homilies on Matthew 27).



ELISHA'S CALL · 1 KINGS 19:19-21

He forsook the oxen and ran

ELISHA · 1 KINGS 19:20

“Please let me kiss my father and my mother, then I will follow you.”

THE DISCIPLE · MATTHEW 8:21

“Lord, permit me first to go and bury my father.”

FROM THE VIDEO Elijah passes by and throws his mantle on Elisha without stopping, so Elisha must decide at once; he has to run after him. (This is where we get 'passing the mantle.') Twelve pairs of oxen suggest Elisha was wealthy. 1 Kings 19:19

FROM THE VIDEO Elijah's reply, 'Go back again, for what have I done to you?', is mysterious. The video's proposal: Elijah puts the ball back in Elisha's court and trusts God, who had told him Elisha would replace him (19:16). 1 Kings 19:16

FROM THE VIDEO The text never says Elisha kissed his parents. He sacrificed the oxen, cooked them with the yoke, and gave the meat away. He 'burned the ships': nothing to go back to. 1 Kings 19:21

◆ Factbook: Elisha ◆ Factbook: Elijah (prophet)

LUKE'S ADDITION · LUKE 9:61-62

Hand to the plow

LUKE 9:61-62 (LSB)

NO LOOKING BACK

“Another also said, “I will follow You, Lord, but first permit me to say farewell to those at home.” But Jesus said to him, “No one, after putting his hand to the plow and looking back, is fit for the kingdom of God.””

FROM THE VIDEO Luke makes the Elisha connection clear: a plow and a farewell to home. What Elisha realized, every disciple must realize.

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus also says, 'none of you can be My disciple who does not give up all his own possessions' (Luke 14:33).

Luke 14:28-33

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven

> *“In order to be a disciple of Jesus, the only thing that comes first is doing the will of the Father.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The storm on the sea

Why seasoned fishermen were terrified, and what Jesus' rebuke means.

THE STORM · MATTHEW 8:23-25

A great seismos

MATTHEW 8:24-25 (LSB)

SHAKING

“And behold, there arose a great storm on the sea, so that the boat was being covered with the waves; but Jesus Himself was sleeping. And they came to Him and got Him up, saying, “Save us, Lord; we are perishing!””

FROM THE VIDEO The word for 'storm' is seismos, literally a shaking or earthquake. Matthew uses it again at the cross and the empty tomb, which suggests something spiritual is going on. Matthew 27:54 Matthew 28:2

FROM THE VIDEO Why were seasoned fishermen so afraid? This was no ordinary storm.

BACKGROUND Added: Jonah also slept through a great storm on the sea while the sailors feared they would perish (Jonah 1:4-6).

Jonah 1:4-6

◆ Factbook: Sea of Galilee ◆ Factbook: Fishing

THE REBUKE · MATTHEW 8:26

He rebuked the winds and the sea

THE SEA · MATTHEW 8:26

“Then He got up and rebuked the winds and the sea, and it became perfectly calm.”

A SPIRIT · MARK 1:25

“And Jesus rebuked him, saying, “Be quiet, and come out of him!””

FROM THE VIDEO 'Rebuked' is the word Jesus uses with unclean spirits (Mark 1:25; 9:25; Luke 4:41). He does not merely calm this storm; He seems to exorcise it. Mark 9:25 Luke 4:41

BACKGROUND Mark has Him say to the sea, 'Silence! Be still' (Mark 4:39), the same 'be quiet' (phimoō) He says to the spirit in Mark 1:25. Mark 4:39

◆ Factbook: Demon possession

THE DEEP · GENESIS 1:2

Darkness over the deep

GENESIS 1:2 (LSB)

CHAOS

“And the earth was formless and void, and darkness was over the surface of the deep, and the Spirit of God was hovering over the surface of the waters.”

FROM THE VIDEO The video says Jews saw the Sea of Galilee, and the sea in general, as the watery chaos of Genesis 1:2. The sea was called the abyss: the gateway to the underworld where evil spirits dwelt.

BACKGROUND Only God rules the sea in Israel's songs: 'When its waves rise, You still them' (Psalm 89:9). 'He caused the storm to stand still' (Psalm 107:29). So: 'What kind of a man is this?' (8:27). Psalm 89:9 Psalm 107:23-30

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms

> *“Jesus does not merely calm this storm. He appears to exorcise the storm.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

The other side: tombs, swine and Bashan

The video's 'unseen realm' reading of the crossing. Much of it is debated; see Debates and Careful reading.

THE TOMBS · MATTHEW 8:28-29

Before the time

MATTHEW 8:28-29 (LSB)

UNCLEAN

“And when He came to the other side, into the region of the Gadarenes, two men who were demon-possessed met Him as they were coming out of the tombs. They were so extremely violent that no one could pass by that way. And behold, they cried out, saying, “What do we have to do with You, Son of God? Have You come here to torment us before the time?””

FROM THE VIDEO In Second Temple Judaism demons were 'unclean spirits.' The video says many Jews thought they came from the realm of the dead, and like corpses they were unclean. Jesus removes that uncleanness from the men.

FROM THE VIDEO In Luke they plead 'not to command them to go away into the abyss' (Luke 8:31): back where they came from. 'Before the time' means the end the demons know is coming. **Luke 8:31**

BACKGROUND Mark: 'My name is Legion; for we are many' (Mark 5:9). A Roman legion was about 5,000 soldiers. **Mark 5:9**

◆ Factbook: Demon possession ◆ Factbook: God the Son ◆ Factbook: Gadara



THE NATIONS · DEUTERONOMY 32:8-9

The boundaries of the peoples

🗺 **DEUTERONOMY 32:8-9 (LSB)** NATIONS

“When the Most High gave the nations their inheritance, / When He separated the sons of man, / He set the boundaries of the peoples / According to the number of the sons of Israel. / For Yahweh’s portion is His people; / Jacob is the allotment of His inheritance.”

FROM THE VIDEO The video reads 'sons of God' in verse 8 (see Careful reading). With Michael Heiser, it says these sons of God were members of God's divine council who were given the nations, failed them (Psalm 82) and let the nations worship them: demons. Until Jesus, these borders were not crossed. **Psalm 82:6-7**

BACKGROUND Moses: 'They sacrificed to demons who were not God' (Deuteronomy 32:17). Paul: 'the things which the Gentiles sacrifice, they sacrifice to demons' (1 Corinthians 10:20). **Deuteronomy 32:17** **1 Corinthians 10:20**

◆ Factbook: Gentiles ◆ Factbook: Book of Deuteronomy



BASHAN · PSALM 68

He led captive a host of captives

PSALM 68 · PSALM 68:15-16

“A mountain of God is the mountain of Bashan; / A mountain of many peaks is the mountain of Bashan. / Why do you look with envy, O mountains with many peaks, / At the mountain which God has prized for His habitation?”

PAUL · EPHESIANS 4:8

“When He ascended on high, / He led captive a host of captives, / And He gave gifts to men.”

FROM THE VIDEO The east shore is Gentile land, the Decapolis, which the video links with Bashan, seen as the entry point of the underworld. Crossing the lake, Jesus crosses the abyss into enemy ground.

FROM THE VIDEO Paul quotes Psalm 68 for Christ's triumph. The video: the Lord invades Bashan, takes prisoners, and reclaims it, undoing the division of the nations in Deuteronomy 32. Jesus casts out a whole legion and stills the sea.

BACKGROUND Paul says the rulers of this age did not understand God's wisdom, 'for if they had understood it, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory' (1 Corinthians 2:8). **1 Corinthians 2:8**

◆ Factbook: Decapolis



The two possessed men

James Tissot, The Possessed Men Dwelling in the Tombs, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"Geography is important. The authors don't mention geography for no reason.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 8:18-34

What the video says, then a short background note.

Jesus

VIDEO Calls disciples to put the Father's will first, stills a storm, and drives out a legion of demons on Gentile ground.

BACKGROUND 'Son of Man' (8:20) is the name Jesus uses most for Himself.

Daniel 7:13-14 ◆ Jesus Christ

The scribe

VIDEO A Torah expert who wants to follow Jesus, unusually; he must learn the cost.

BACKGROUND Matthew mentions a scribe 'who has become a disciple of the kingdom of heaven' (13:52).

Matthew 13:52 ◆ Scribe

The would-be disciple

VIDEO Wants first to bury his father; perhaps to wait until his father dies.

BACKGROUND Burying parents was a weighty duty in Judaism.

Matthew 8:21-22

Elijah and Elisha

VIDEO The model of a call to discipleship: Elijah throws his mantle; Elisha leaves everything.

BACKGROUND Elisha later receives a double portion of Elijah's spirit (2 Kings 2:9-15).

1 Kings 19:19-21 ◆ Elijah (prophet) ◆ Elisha

◆ Mantle

The disciples

VIDEO Seasoned fishermen, terrified by a storm they should have known how to handle.

BACKGROUND 'You men of little faith' (8:26): Matthew's word for disciples who believe, but weakly (6:30; 14:31).

Matthew 6:30 ◆ Disciples ◆ Fishing

The two demoniacs

VIDEO From the tombs, so violent no one could pass; the demons know Jesus is the Son of God.

BACKGROUND Mark and Luke focus on one man, who then tells the Decapolis what Jesus did (Mark 5:20).

Mark 5:1-20 ◆ Demon possession ◆ Decapolis

Michael Heiser

VIDEO Named in the video for reading the 'sons of God' as God's divine council.

BACKGROUND A biblical scholar (1963-2023) known for The Unseen Realm (2015).

Psalm 82 ◆ Divine council

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

Crossing to the other side

Coral pins are mentioned in the passage; gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background --- To 'the other side' (8:18, 28); the exact route is unknown

Positions from known sites; Kursi is the traditional site, and Bashan's borders are approximate (roughly the Golan and Hauran, north-east of the lake). Coastline of the lake and rivers: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL); land: Natural Earth (public domain).

Capernaum BACKGROUND

Jesus' base on the west shore, where the crossing likely began.

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

Kursi BACKGROUND

The traditional site of the miracle on the east shore, with a steep slope near the water; often linked with Gergesa.

◆ Factbook: Kursi

Gadara VIDEO

'The region of the Gadarenes' (8:28): this Decapolis city controlled land toward the lake.

Hippos BACKGROUND

Another Decapolis city on the east shore.

◆ Factbook: Hippos ◆ Factbook: Decapolis

◆ Factbook: Gadara ◆ Factbook: Decapolis

Tiberias BACKGROUND

On the west shore, in Jewish Galilee.

◆ Factbook: Tiberias

Magdala BACKGROUND

Fishing town on the west shore.

◆ Factbook: Magdala

08

Key terms

Scribe

VIDEO

An expert in the Law; some served in the temple, at court, or on the Sanhedrin.

◆ Factbook: Scribe

Son of Man

BACKGROUND

Jesus' favorite title for Himself, drawn from Daniel 7:13-14.

◆ Factbook: Son of Man

Seismos

VIDEO

A shaking or earthquake; Matthew's word for the storm (8:24).

Abyss

VIDEO

The deep; in Jewish thought, the prison of evil spirits (Luke 8:31; Revelation 20:3).

◆ Factbook: Abyss

Unclean spirits

VIDEO

The New Testament's other name for demons (Mark 1:23; 5:2).

◆ Factbook: Demon possession

Divine council

VIDEO

God's heavenly assembly (Psalm 82:1). The video, following Michael Heiser, reads the 'sons of God' as its members.

◆ Factbook: Divine council ◆ Factbook: Sons of God

Bashan

VIDEO

The fertile highlands north-east of the Sea of Galilee (roughly the Golan and Hauran), famous for its bulls and oaks.

◆ Factbook: Bashan

Passing the mantle

VIDEO

From Elijah throwing his cloak on Elisha (1 Kings 19:19): a call and an anointing.

◆ Factbook: Elisha ◆ Factbook: Mantle

Double-minded

VIDEO

Divided in loyalty; 'unstable in all his ways' (James 1:8).

◆ Factbook: Hypocrite

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

ἀλώπηξ

alōpēx G258

Fox (also used of Herod, Luke 13:32).

Greek · Matt 8:20

θάπτω

thaptō G2290

To bury.

Greek · Matt 8:21, 22

σεισμός

seismos G4578

Shaking, earthquake; here a storm.

Greek · Matt 8:24

δειλός

deilos G1169

Cowardly, fearful.

Greek · Matt 8:26

ὀλιγόπιστος

oligopistos G3640

'Of little faith.'

Greek · Matt 8:26

◆ Factbook: Disciples

ἐπιτιμάω

epitimaō G2008

To rebuke; used of demons and fever too.

Greek · Matt 8:26

γαλήνη

galēnē G1055

Calm (of the sea).

Greek · Matt 8:26

δαιμονίζομαι

daimonizomai G1139

To be demon-possessed.

Greek · Matt 8:28

◆ Factbook: Demon possession

μνημεῖον

mnēmeion G3419

Tomb.

βασανίζω

basanizō G928

To torment.

Greek · Matt 8:28

Greek · Matt 8:29

καιρός

kairos G2540

The appointed time.

Greek · Matt 8:29

ἄβυσσος

abyssos G12

Abyss, the deep.

Greek · Luke 8:31

◆ Factbook: Abyss

λεγιών

legiōn G3003

Legion: a Roman unit of about 5,000 soldiers.

Greek · Mark 5:9

◆ Factbook: Legion (Roman army unit)

אַדֶּרֶת

ʾadderet H155

Mantle, cloak.

Hebrew · 1 Kgs 19:19

◆ Factbook: Mantle

בָּשָׁן

Bashan H1316

Bashan.

Hebrew · Ps 68:15

◆ Factbook: Bashan

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Storms on the lake

The Sea of Galilee lies about 210 m below sea level, ringed by hills. Cool winds can drop through the valleys and whip up violent storms with little warning.

Gadarenes, Gerasenes, Gergesenes

Matthew says 'Gadarenes,' Mark and Luke 'Gerasenes,' and some manuscripts 'Gergesenes.' Gadara was a nearby Decapolis city; Kursi on the east shore is the traditional site.

Pigs in the Decapolis

Pigs were unclean to Jews (Leviticus 11:7), but the Greek cities east of the lake raised them. A large herd marks this as Gentile land.

Tombs and the unclean

Touching a corpse or a grave made a person unclean (Numbers 19:16). Men living among the tombs were as cut off as they could be.

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *"And surely it is far better to proclaim the kingdom, and draw back others from death, than to bury the dead body, that is nothing advantaged thereby;*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 27, on 8:21-22. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *"That is, His power to rebuke when awakened they knew, but that He could do so even sleeping, they knew not as yet.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 28, on 8:24-26. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *"Everywhere they have labored to drive men to dismay, and everywhere they rejoice in destruction.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 28, on 8:32. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

Was the father already dead?

Many scholars (and the video) read 'bury my father' as 'wait until he dies.' Others, like Chrysostom, take it literally: even a funeral must not come before following Jesus.

Why did the demons live in tombs?

The video: many Jews thought unclean spirits came from the realm of the dead (an idea found in 1 Enoch). Chrysostom rejected the idea that 'the souls of the dead become demons.'

'Sons of God' and the divine council

The video follows Michael Heiser's reading of Deuteronomy 32:8 and Psalm 82: rebel heavenly beings over the nations. Others read Psalm 82's 'gods' as human judges (compare John 10:34-35).

One demoniac or two?

Matthew has two; Mark and Luke tell of one. Many think Mark and Luke focus on the one who spoke or who later preached in the Decapolis (Mark 5:20).

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Deuteronomy 32:8 reads 'the sons of Israel' in the LSB. The video's 'sons of God' follows the Dead Sea Scrolls and the Greek Old Testament, which some newer translations adopt. Both readings exist; the video's argument depends on the second.
- Psalm 68:15-16 says Bashan's many-peaked mountain looks with envy at the mountain God chose for His home. The psalm does not say God ascends Bashan; that reading, of God conquering Bashan, is the video's (following Heiser).

- Bashan lay mainly north-east of the lake (the Golan and Hauran). The Decapolis and Bashan overlap only in part, and Gadara sat south-east of the lake.
- The video cites Ephesians 3, where 3:10 says God's wisdom is now made known to the rulers and authorities. The verse that says the rulers did not understand is 1 Corinthians 2:8.
- 1 Kings 19 is a classic call story, but not the first account of discipleship: Joshua was Moses' attendant long before (Exodus 24:13).

11 · BACKGROUND

From Moses' song to Kursi

Coral dots mark what Matthew 8:18-34 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1400 BC DEBATED
Moses' song: the Most High sets the nations' boundaries
Deuteronomy 32:8

C. 860 BC
Elijah throws his mantle on Elisha
1 Kings 19:19 *Echo: 8:21-22*

C. AD 28 DEBATED
The storm, and the demoniacs on the east shore
Matthew 8:18-34 *This episode*

C. AD 60 DEBATED
Paul quotes Psalm 68 of Christ's triumph
Ephesians 4:8

C. AD 390
Chrysostom preaches on the storm and the swine
Matthew 8:24

5TH CENTURY
A monastery and church built at Kursi
Matthew 8:28

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Mark 4:35-5:20
Mark's storm and the Gerasene demoniac
ADDED

Luke 8:22-39
Luke's account; the abyss
ADDED

Luke 9:57-62

Jonah 1:4-16

Would-be followers; the plow

ADDED

A sleeping prophet in a great storm

ADDED

Psalm 107:23-32

He caused the storm to stand still

ADDED

Psalm 89:8-10

You rule the swelling of the sea

ADDED

Colossians 2:15

He disarmed the rulers and authorities

ADDED

James 1:5-8

The double-minded man

ADDED

Philippians 3:7-14

Forgetting what lies behind

ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. What is on your 'checklist of things to do first' before fully obeying God?
2. Elisha burned the plow and cooked the oxen. What would 'nothing to go back to' look like for you?
3. The disciples were experts on the water and still terrified. When has your experience failed you?
4. Jesus slept in the storm. What does that tell you about Him, and about fear?
5. The townspeople begged Jesus to leave after He freed two men. Why might people prefer their pigs to Jesus?
6. Where are you double-minded right now? What is one step toward a single focus?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

The lesson for the original audience: to be a disciple of Jesus, the only thing that comes first is doing the will of the Father. There is no checklist of things to do first. Seek first the kingdom (6:33); the one who enters is the one who does the Father's will (7:21). Jesus invites would-be disciples to the same realization Elisha had: forsake all and follow at once. Every day we face the choice to obey God or press pause to do what we think is better, and there is no room for double-mindedness, the condition of the hypocrite. Think about how this applies directly to your life so that you can do something about it.

name one thing you have told God 'first let me…' about. Like Elisha, take one concrete step this week that makes going back harder, and tell a friend so they can encourage you.

> *"There is absolutely no room for this kind of double-mindedness.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Joshua (son of Nun) ◆ Moses ◆ Dead Sea Scrolls ◆ Holy Spirit ◆ Galilee ◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Elijah (prophet) ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Capernaum ◆ Decapolis ◆ Book of Deuteronomy ◆ Book of Psalms ◆ Worship ◆ God the Son ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Demon possession ◆ Disciples ◆ Elisha ◆ Fishing ◆ Gadara ◆ Gentiles ◆ Hippos ◆ Hypocrite ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Magdala ◆ Sanhedrin ◆ Scribe ◆ Sea of Galilee ◆ Tiberias ◆ Abyss ◆ Bashan ◆ Daniel (the prophet) ◆ Divine council ◆ James (brother of Jesus) ◆ Kursi ◆ Legion (Roman army unit) ◆ Mantle ◆ Matthew (apostle) ◆ Paul ◆ Son of Man ◆ Sons of God ◆ Swine

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